Chocolate by the Spoonful

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Smooth, creamy and deeply chocolatey, this is my homemade take on the little chocolate dessert pots we buy ready-made.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 10 min · Cook 10 min

INGREDIENTS

- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 3 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 3 tbsp cornstarch
- ¼ tsp salt
- 2¾ cups whole milk
- ¼ cup heavy cream
- 1 cup dark chocolate chips
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Combine the dry ingredients. Whisk the brown sugar, cocoa powder, cornstarch and salt together in a medium saucepan, breaking up any lumps.
2. Add the milk and cream. Gradually whisk in a little of the cold milk to form a smooth paste. Slowly add the remaining milk and the cream, whisking until evenly combined.
3. Cook until thickened. Place over medium heat and cook, whisking constantly and reaching into the corners of the pan, until the mixture thickens and begins to bubble. Reduce the heat and continue cooking for approximately 1 minute, still whisking.
4. Add the chocolate. Remove from the heat. Add the dark chocolate chips and vanilla, then stir until the chocolate has melted and the pudding is smooth.
5. Portion and chill. Divide between 6–8 heatproof dessert cups. For a smooth surface without a skin, press food wrap suitable for hot food directly onto the pudding. Refrigerate promptly for at least 3 hours, until cold and set.
6. Serve chilled.

Tip

Start with cold milk. Mix the cornstarch thoroughly into the cold liquid before heating to prevent lumps.